

General Knowledge

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STUDY NOTES

Defence Forces

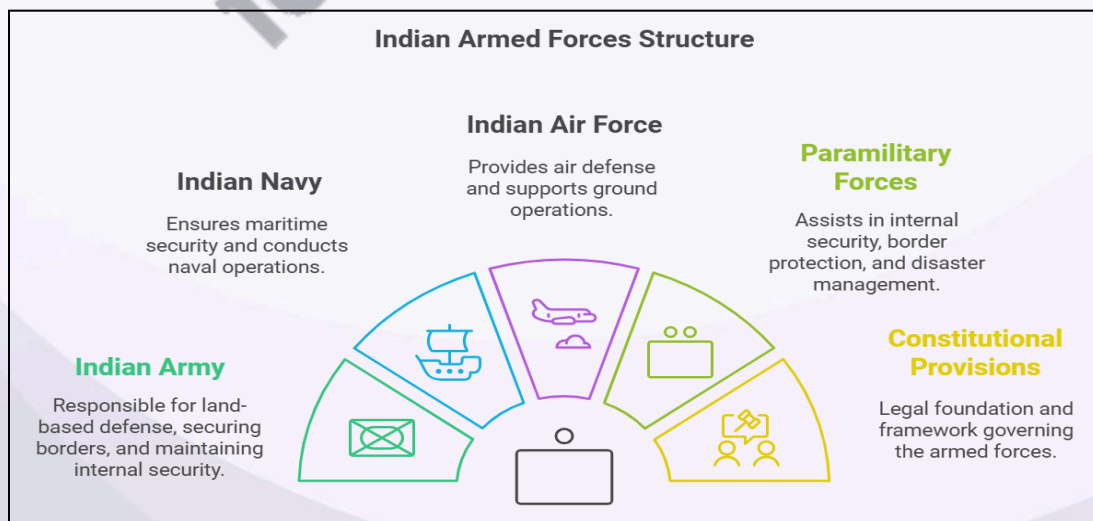


Defence Forces



Introduction

- The Indian Armed Forces are the military forces responsible for the defense of India. They consist of three branches:
 - **Indian Army (land-based forces)**
 - **Indian Navy (sea-based forces)**
 - **Indian Air Force (air-based forces)**
- The primary role of the Indian Armed Forces is to safeguard India's **sovereignty**, maintain **internal security**, and support **peacekeeping operations** globally.
- The supportive defense forces of India include **paramilitary forces**, **police**, and specialized units like the **NSG**, **Coast Guard**, and **NDRF**, which assist in maintaining the internal security, border protection, and disaster management.



Constitutional and Legal Provisions

- The Indian Constitution provides the legal foundation for the armed forces.
 - **Article 33:** Authorizes **Parliament** to modify the laws related to the armed forces.
 - **Article 34:** Empowers Parliament to make laws relating to the restriction of **fundamental rights** of armed forces members.
 - **Article 61:** Deals with the process of impeachment of **the President**, which includes **command** over the armed forces.

Structure of the Indian Armed Forces:

Indian Army:

- The Indian Army is responsible for the land-based defense of India.
- It secures borders, maintains internal security, and participates in peacekeeping missions globally.
- Headquarters: New Delhi.

Organizational Structure:

- **Commands:** The Indian Army is divided into 7 commands, each headed by a General Officer Commanding-in-Chief (GOC-in-C). Some important commands include:
 - **Northern Command:** Based in Udhampur, Jammu and Kashmir, focusing on the borders with Pakistan and China.
 - **Western Command:** Headquartered in Chandimandir, Haryana, guarding the Western front with Pakistan.
 - **Eastern Command:** Located in Kolkata, securing the Eastern borders with China and Myanmar.
 - **Southern Command:** Based in Pune, Maharashtra, maintaining internal security and operations in the southern states.
 - **Central Command:** Headquartered in Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh, acting as a reserve force for Northern and Western fronts.
 - **South Western Command:** Located in Jaipur, Rajasthan, operating along the Rajasthan-Punjab axis.
 - **Army Training Command (ARTRAC):** Based in Shimla, Himachal Pradesh, responsible for training and doctrine development.

Major Divisions of the Indian Army

- The Major Divisions of the Indian Army encompass specialized units and regiments that are central to executing diverse land warfare strategies and maintaining comprehensive ground defense.
 - **Infantry:** The backbone of the Army, with regiments like the Gorkhas, Rajputana Rifles, and Sikh Regiment, specialized in diverse terrains.
 - **Armored Corps:** Main Battle Tanks (MBTs) like the T-90 Bhishma and Arjun MBT, and armored vehicles for heavy combat roles.
 - **Artillery:** Field artillery with guns like the Bofors gun and rocket artillery such as the Pinaka MBRL (Multi Barrel Rocket Launcher).
 - **Corps of Engineers:** In charge of combat engineering, construction of bridges, and fortifications.
 - **Corps of Signals:** Maintains military communication networks.
 - **Army Aviation Corps:** Operates helicopters like HAL Dhruv for reconnaissance, logistic support, and troop transport.
 - **Special Forces:** Para SF (Special Forces), conducting specialized operations like counter-terrorism, hostage rescue, and reconnaissance.

Indian Navy

- The Indian Navy is tasked with safeguarding India's vast maritime frontiers, securing critical shipping lanes, and enhancing naval presence in regional and international waters.

Commands of the Indian Navy

- The Commands of the Indian Navy are organized to effectively manage naval operations across India's extensive maritime borders and fulfill various defense and strategic objectives.
 - **Western Naval Command:** Based in Mumbai, Maharashtra, overseeing operations in the Arabian Sea.
 - **Eastern Naval Command:** Headquartered in Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh, responsible for the Bay of Bengal.
 - **Southern Naval Command:** Training command located in Kochi, Kerala.

Key Components of the Indian Navy

- The Key Components of the Indian Navy are designed to maintain maritime dominance, safeguard sea lanes, and project power through a diverse fleet of ships, submarines, and aircraft.
 - **Aircraft Carriers:** **INS Vikramaditya** and **INS Vikrant**, serve as the primary floating air bases, projecting maritime power.
 - **Submarine Fleet:** Includes both conventional diesel-electric submarines (like the Scorpene class) and nuclear-powered submarines (such as INS Arihant).
 - **Surface Warships:** **Destroyers** (e.g., INS Kolkata), **frigates** (e.g., INS Shivalik), **corvettes** (e.g., Kamorta class), and **missile boats**.
 - **Naval Aviation:** Operates aircraft like **MiG-29K** fighters, **P-8I Poseidon maritime patrol aircraft**, and various helicopters like **Sea King MK 42B** for anti-submarine warfare.
 - **Marine Commando Force (MARCOS):** An elite special operations unit skilled in **maritime warfare, amphibious assaults, and counter-terrorism operations**.

Indian Air Force

- The Indian Air Force (IAF) is responsible for securing Indian airspace and executing aerial warfare operations, emphasizing air superiority, ground support, and logistical capabilities.

Commands of the Indian Air Force

- The Commands of the **Indian Air Force** are strategically distributed to ensure comprehensive defense coverage and efficient operational control over India's airspace.
 - **Western Air Command:** Based in New Delhi, the largest command responsible for air defense over Northern and Western India.
 - **Eastern Air Command:** Headquartered in Shillong, Meghalaya, ensuring air defense along India's eastern front.
 - **Central Air Command:** Located in Prayagraj (Allahabad), Uttar Pradesh, providing logistic support and reinforcements.
 - **Southern Air Command:** Centered in Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala, guarding the southern peninsula and maritime airspaces.
 - **South Western Air Command:** Based in Gandhinagar, Gujarat, covering the nation's western desert areas.
 - **Training Command:** Located in Bengaluru, Karnataka, focusing on training pilots and technical staff.

- **Maintenance Command:** Headquartered in Nagpur, Maharashtra, overseeing maintenance and logistical support for IAF's equipment and bases.

Key Aircraft and Units of the Indian Air Force

- The Key Aircraft and Units of the Indian Air Force form the backbone of India's aerial defense, leveraging cutting-edge technology and versatile capabilities for air superiority, transport, and reconnaissance.
 - **Fighter Jets:** Su-30MKI, Rafale, Mirage 2000, MiG-29, and Tejas (a Light Combat Aircraft developed indigenously).
 - **Transport Aircraft:** C-130J Super Hercules, C-17 Globemaster III, and IL-76 for strategic and tactical airlift operations.
 - **Helicopters:** Apache AH-64E for attack operations, Chinook for heavy lift, and Dhruv for multi-role usage.
 - **Surveillance:** AWACS (Airborne Warning and Control System) and UAVs (Unmanned Aerial Vehicles) for reconnaissance.
 - **Special Forces:** Garud Commando Force, specializing in search and rescue operations, counter-terrorism, and airborne assaults.

Ranks of Armed Forces

Rank	Indian Army	Indian Navy	Indian Air Force
1. Highest Rank	Chief of Defence Staff	Chief of Defence Staff	Chief of Defence Staff
2. Senior Officer Rank	General	Admiral (5-star)	Marshal of the Air Force
3. Lieutenant General	Lieutenant General	Vice Admiral	Air Marshal
4. Major General	Major General	Rear Admiral	Air Vice Marshal
5. Brigadier	Brigadier	Commodore	Group Captain
6. Colonel	Colonel	Captain	Wing Commander

7. Lieutenant Colonel	Lieutenant Colonel	Commander	Squadron Leader
8. Major	Major	Lieutenant Commander	Flight Lieutenant
9. Captain	Captain	Lieutenant	Flying Officer
10. Lieutenant	Lieutenant	Sub-Lieutenant	Pilot Officer
11. Senior Non-Commissioned Officer	Subedar Major	Master Warrant Officer	Warrant Officer
12. Non-Commissioned Officer (NCO)	Subedar	Warrant Officer	Flight Sergeant
13. Junior Non-Commissioned Officer (JNCO)	Havildar	Chief Petty Officer	Sergeant
14. Entry-Level Rank	Naik	Leading Seaman	Leading Aircraftman
15. Lowest Rank	Sepoy / Soldier	Seaman	Aircraftman

Other Forces

- In addition to the primary branches, several other forces bolster India's defense capabilities, ensuring a comprehensive security framework.
- **Paramilitary Forces:** These include the Border Security Force (BSF), Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF), and Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP), which provide critical support during conflicts, manage border security, and handle internal disturbance scenarios.
- **Indian Coast Guard:** Responsible for maritime law enforcement, coastal security, and **SAR (Search and Rescue)** operations within India's maritime zones.

- Strategic Forces Command (SFC): Oversees India's strategic and nuclear arsenal, ensuring operational readiness and security.
- **Special Frontier Force (SFF):** Conducts covert operations and special missions, often focused on high-risk and high-altitude environments.

Paramilitary Force	Establishment Year	Ministry	Motto	Key Features
Border Security Force (BSF)	1965	Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)	"Seva and Nishtha" (Service and Loyalty)	- Primary role: Border security, guarding borders with Pakistan and Bangladesh.
				- Largest border guarding force in the world.
				- Engaged in anti-smuggling, anti-terrorist, and anti-naxal operations.
Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF)	1939	Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)	"Seva Paramo Dharma" (Service is the Supreme Duty)	- Provides internal security and law enforcement during civil disturbances.
				- Involved in counter-insurgency, anti-terrorism, and maintaining law and order.
Central Industrial Security Force (CISF)	1969	Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)	"Security with a Smile"	- Protects critical infrastructure (airports, seaports, nuclear power plants, etc.).
				- Engaged in disaster management and providing security to public sector undertakings (PSUs).
Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP)	1962	Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)	"Himveer" (The Braveheart)	- Guards the Indo-Tibetan (China) border.
				- Specializes in mountain warfare and high-altitude operations.
National Security Guard (NSG)	1984	Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)	"Sarvatra, Isha, Satyam" (Everywhere)	- Elite counter-terrorism and hostage rescue force.
				- Handles high-profile security threats and national

			e, Truth)	emergencies.
Sashastra Seema Bal (SSB)	1963	Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)	"Seva aur Samarpan" (Service and Dedication)	- Guards the borders with Nepal and Bhutan.
				- Works in close cooperation with the local community to prevent cross-border crime.
Assam Rifles	1835	Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)	"Faithful, Service, and Loyalty"	- Oldest paramilitary force, primarily responsible for the North-East region of India.
				- Engaged in counter-insurgency, border security, and law enforcement.
Rashtriya Rifles (RR)	1990	Ministry of Defence	"Dhristi, Shakti, Sankalp" (Vision, Strength, Resolve)	- Specially formed to tackle insurgency in Jammu and Kashmir.
				- Works alongside the Indian Army in counter-insurgency operations in the region.
National Disaster Response Force (NDRF)	2006	Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)	"Aapda Seva Hi Param Dharma Hai" (Service to Humanity is the Highest Duty)	- Specializes in disaster response and rescue operations.
				- Trained in rescuing victims of natural disasters like floods, earthquakes, and cyclones.
Coast Guard	1978	Ministry of Defence	"Vayam Raksham" (We Protect)	- Protects India's maritime interests, guards the coastline, and provides maritime security.
				- Engaged in search and rescue, anti-smuggling, and marine pollution control.

Integrated Theatre Command

- The concept of Integrated Theatre Command (ITC) represents a significant strategic shift towards a more unified and synergized approach in the Indian Armed Forces.

- The ITC aims to amalgamate resources from the **Army, Navy, and Air Force** under a **single operational command** for better coordination and execution of military strategies.

Purpose of the Integrated Theatre Commands

- **Efficiency:** By integrating units from different services under one command, ITC ensures more efficient use of resources and enhances combat effectiveness.
- **Quick Decision Making:** Streamlined command structures facilitate faster decision-making processes compared to separate command structures in the existing system.
- **Enhanced Readiness:** Joint planning and training under ITC improve the preparedness of forces to respond swiftly to various threats.

Implementation of the Integrated Theatre Commands

- The move towards **ITC** involves a phased approach. The Indian government, under the purview of the **Chief of Defence Staff**, is gradually transforming the traditional command structure to address new security needs.
- **Geographical Theatre Commands:** Initially proposed theatre commands include the Western Theatre Command facing Pakistan and the Eastern Theatre Command oriented towards China. Each will have integrated elements from the Army, Navy, and Air Force tailored to specific regional threats.
- **Logistical and Cyber Commands:** Dedicated commands for cyber and space warfare will handle the growing complexities of modern warfare, ensuring critical domains like logistics and digital security receive focused attention.
- **Special Operations Command:** Integrating special forces across the three branches will optimize the execution of high-risk operations.